

Rowlett Group of Alcoholics Anonymous

This packet contains the documents used by the Rowlett Group to support clear, simple, and effective group service. These materials are designed to help any member understand how the group operates and how they can serve.

Table of Contents

1. Rowlett Group Bylaws
2. Rowlett Group Service Guide
3. Group Meeting Guidelines

How the Documents Work Together

1. The Bylaws constitute the governing document of the Rowlett Group.
2. The Service Guide and Meeting Guidelines are not bylaws and are intended as shared practices, operational guidance, and descriptions of service responsibilities. They may be revised more simply as the needs of the group evolve.

Amendment Thresholds

1. Bylaws: 2/3 majority + 30 days notice
2. Service Guide: 2/3 majority
3. Meeting Guidelines: Simple Majority

Section 1: ROWLETT GROUP BYLAWS

Rowlett Group Bylaws Revision: March 2026

These Bylaws are approved for the conduct and operation of the Rowlett Group of Alcoholics Anonymous and are based upon the Twelve Traditions of AA and derived from the pamphlet, The AA Group, published by the General Service Organization.

In all matters, the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous shall guide the actions and decisions of the Rowlett Group.

1. Our Purpose

Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics achieve sobriety, in keeping with the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

2. The Group Conscience

The Group Conscience is the ultimate authority for the Group (Tradition Two). Its collective spiritual decisions are expressed through motions and votes taken at official Group Conscience meetings.

- a. A regular Group Conscience meeting for the transaction of all Group business shall be held monthly at a day and time set by the Service Board and announced to membership.
- b. Special Group Conscience meetings may be called by the Chairperson for issues or items that require timely resolution for the common welfare of the group.

3. Service Board

- a. The Service Board shall act as the steering committee for the group and is comprised of all elected Trusted Servants.
- b. Positions, Qualifications, and Duties: The specific Trusted Servant positions, their term lengths, minimum sobriety requirements, qualifications, and detailed descriptions of duties shall be outlined in the Manual of Trusted Servant Positions.
- c. Elections for all open Trusted Servant positions shall be held at the regular Group Conscience meeting in November of each year.
- d. Procedure: Elections shall be conducted in a manner that places "principles before personalities" (Tradition Twelve). For any position where more than one person is nominated, the election shall be conducted using the Third Legacy Procedure.
- e. Vacancies: Should a vacancy occur in any position, it shall be announced by the Chairperson at the next regular Group Conscience meeting. A special election shall be held at that meeting to fill the remainder of the unexpired term.
- f. Removal from Office: Any Trusted Servant may be removed from their position for just cause (such as loss of continuous sobriety, willful failure to perform duties, or actions that threaten the Group's welfare or unity) by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of eligible members present at a Group Conscience meeting.
- g. Ad Hoc Committees: The Chairperson, with the approval of the Service Board, may appoint ad hoc (temporary) committees as needed to carry out specific short-term activities of the Group.

4. Membership and Voting

Any person having a desire to stop drinking may be a member of the Rowlett Group. All members are encouraged to attend Group Conscience meetings.

Eligibility for voting is extended to members who:

- a. Regularly attend the Rowlett Group,
- b. Consider Rowlett to be their home group,
- c. Have three (3) months of continuous sobriety.

5. Conduct of Group Conscience Meetings

Group Conscience meetings should tend to be informal, permitting full participation of members. Robert's Rules of Order shall be used as a general guide in the conducting of meetings.

6. Adoption and Amendment of Bylaws, Trusted Servant Manual and Meeting Guidelines

Initial adoption of these Bylaws shall require a two-thirds (2/3) majority of eligible members in attendance.

Subsequent amendments shall require a two-thirds (2/3) majority of eligible members present at a Group Conscience meeting, with thirty (30) days' notice of proposed amendments.

7. Decision Making and Minority Opinion

- a. Major Issues & Motions: When sensitive or major issues arise that affect the Group, these should be tabled (after appropriate discussion) until the next Group Conscience meeting, when final discussion and voting may take place. The motion should be posted for the awareness of all group members. Approval of such major issues requires a two-thirds (2/3) majority of eligible members present. This is to avoid haste and permit full consideration so that an informed group conscience can prevail.
- b. Minor Issues & Motions: Approval of minor issues may be decided with a simple majority (more than 50% of votes cast, excluding abstentions) at the meeting in which it is presented.
- c. Minority Opinion: For all matters brought to vote, the minority opinion should be heard and a revote may be taken if appropriate.
- d. New business items should be written on white board and submitted on Motion Form.

8. Resolved Issues

Once an issue or motion has been resolved (voted passed or failed), it may not be brought before the Group again for a period of three (3) months.

9. Financial

- a. Prudent Reserve: The Rowlett Group shall maintain a prudent reserve equal to approximately three (3) months of operating expenses, currently defined as \$9,000.
- b. Bank Accounts and Signatories: All Group funds shall be kept in a checking account registered in the Group's name. To ensure financial transparency and protect Group funds, all disbursements (checks or electronic payments) shall require the authorization of two (2) signatories. Authorized signatories shall be the Treasurer, Assistant Treasurer, and Chairperson.
- c. Distribution of Surplus Funds: After all Group operating expenses have been met and the Prudent Reserve is fully funded, the Treasurer shall disburse surplus funds on a quarterly basis as directed by the Group Conscience to the service entities Dallas Intergroup Association, Area, District, and General Service Office.
- d. Reimbursement. Trusted servants may be reimbursed for approved group expenses with receipts. This should include reimbursement for travel expenses on behalf of the Rowlett Group approved in advance. This is usually limited to the GSR, GSR Alternate, and Intergroup Representative.

10. Trusted Servant Qualifications

All Trusted Servants of the Rowlett Group should have a minimum period of continuous sobriety and a willingness to serve. Specific sobriety requirements, qualifications, and duties for each position shall be outlined in the Manual of Trusted Servant Positions.

11. Seventh Tradition

In keeping with the Seventh Tradition of Alcoholics Anonymous, the Rowlett Group shall be fully self-supporting through voluntary contributions of its members and shall decline outside contributions.

12. Group Safety and Unity

The Rowlett Group is committed to maintaining an atmosphere of recovery, safety, and mutual respect in all meetings and group activities. The Group Conscience may take appropriate action when behavior disrupts meetings or threatens the unity or safety of the group.

Historical Amendments

Group Guidelines were adopted at a Special Called Group Conscience meeting August 1, 1999. Subsequent amendments were approved as follows:

December 5, 1999 – Members with at least three months sobriety may chair meetings with sponsor present.

September 9, 2001 – Changed length of term for various offices.

February 2, 2002 – Increased Prudent Reserve from \$2,500 to \$3,500; document title changed from Guidelines to Bylaws; Alternate Treasurer position created.

March 9, 2003 – Prudent Reserve increased to \$5,000.

October 9, 2005 – Supplement 'Job Descriptions' approved.

August 10, 2008 – Prudent Reserve increased to \$7,000.

September 11, 2011 – Prudent Reserve increased to \$12,000.

May 13, 2012 – Major issue motions require two-thirds majority.

September 9, 2012 – Chair and Secretary terms changed to one year.

November 11, 2012 – Prudent Reserve adjusted to \$9,000.

September 14, 2014 – Members responsible for group key cost.

November 9, 2014 – Members with three months sobriety may chair meetings with sponsor present.

February 8, 2015 – Chair requirement changed to six months sobriety with sponsor present.

December 11, 2016 – Group will use AA General Service Conference approved literature for discussion.

December 9, 2018 – Trusted Servants preferably have six months sobriety.

June 19, 2023 – Chairperson requirement amendment.

Creation of Facility Liaison position.

Creation of Special Events position.

July 15, 2024 – All six-month service positions changed to one-year terms.

October 21, 202__ – 18 month chips added to meetings and birthday night

Additions to be made:

“These Bylaws supersede and replace all previous versions of the Rowlett Group Bylaws.”

Section 2: ROWLETT GROUP SERVICE GUIDE

Service is an important part of recovery. In Alcoholics Anonymous, our leaders are but trusted servants—they do not govern. This guide briefly describes the service positions in the Rowlett Group and the basic responsibilities of each role so that any member can step into service with confidence.

Chairperson

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- Serves as primary spokesperson and chair of the group, and coordinates activities with other group officers.
- The chair is responsible for presiding over and setting the agenda for group conscience meetings.
- Ensures that group members, especially other officers, are familiar with the *Bylaws* and operations of the group.
- Works with trusted servants to carry out group conscience
- Appoints special committees as needed to carry out activities of the group.

Secretary

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- The secretary is the recorder and historian for the group. Takes minutes at group conscience meeting
- Posts minutes on bulletin board in a timely manner and maintains chronological record of minutes and financial reports in bound form.
- The secretary is responsible for keeping all bulletin boards current and attractive.
- The secretary periodically updates and keeps current the group telephone list
- Maintain Historical Amendment Guide

Treasurer

Term: 2 years | Minimum sobriety: 2 years

- The treasurer keeps clear and accurate records of all group income and expenses; collects and deposits all funds, and keeps reconciled bank records; presents financial report at monthly group conscience meetings and posts up-to-date financial statement on bulletin board, and maintains the prudent reserve as provided in the *Bylaws*.
- This officer pays all bills, purchases, and contributions.
- Usually, the treasurer collects mail and serves as the group correspondent.
- Qualifications for Treasurer must include an adequate level of accounting, bookkeeping, and organizational skills.

Assistant Treasurer

Term: 2 years | Minimum sobriety: 2 years

- Assists the Treasurer
- Performs all the duties of the treasurer in that person's absence.
- This position normally should serve as an apprentice for the future treasurer.

Corrections

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- Keep the home group informed about local Twelfth Step activities in nearby institutions and encourage group members to participate.
- Take A.A. meetings into prisons and jails, where allowed by the correctional facility, to help alcoholic inmates recover and prepare for sober, fulfilling lives after release.
- Maintains contact with District and/or NETA65 committees and represents the home group

Facility Liaison

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- Communicates with the facility or landlord
- Reports maintenance or facility issues
- Helps ensure meeting space is respected and clean
- Facilitates and coordinates information exchange from the group to the landlord and vice versa.
- Reports any safety or maintenance issues to the landlord.
- Coordinates clean up of the room.

General Service Representative (GSR)

Term: 2 years | Minimum sobriety: 2 years

- The GSR, sometimes referred to as the “guardian of the Traditions,” represents the group at district and area assemblies, and keeps members informed about general service activities.
- The GSR or GSR Alternate are expected to attend all appropriate local meetings.
- Upon prior approval, the group shall reimburse this officer for travel expenses (See Bylaw 10).

General Service Representative (GSR) - Alternate

Term: 2 years | Minimum sobriety: 2 years

- Has the same duties and responsibilities as the GSR.
- Coordinates with GSR to ensure that the group is represented at district and area meetings.
- This position normally should serve as an apprenticeship for the future GSR.

Grapevine / La Viña

Term: 6 months | Minimum sobriety: 90 days

- Promotes AA Grapevine and La Viña magazines
- Encourages members to read and contribute stories
- Must have a sponsor
- Familiarize group members with the Fellowship’s international journal, A.A. Grapevine, and its bimonthly Spanish-language magazine La Viña.
- Promote workshops, opportunities for members to submit articles, participate in events and provide subscriptions for schools, corrections facilities, etc.

Intergroup Representative

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- Represents the group at Dallas Intergroup meetings
- Shares local AA service opportunities with the group
- Keeps the group informed about local intergroup activities.

Literature Representative

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 6 months

- Maintains literature rack
- Maintains inventory of literature, chips
- Keeps literature rack supplied

PI / CPC

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- The Public Information/Cooperation with Professional Community chair is the AA information source to the public.
- Serves as the contact person to the professional community, ensuring their awareness of AA and group purposes and activities.
- Maintains contact with District PI/CPC committee and represents the home group

Program Chair

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 6 months

- This officer secures and coordinates speakers for scheduled open speaker, foundations and step speaker meetings; posts advance notice of these speakers for member’s information and publicity.
- The program chair solicits chairpersons for each month for all regularly scheduled group AA meetings.

Special Events

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 3 months

- Organizes birthday night
- Coordinates birthday & special event activities
- Keeps track of monthly birthdays for the group and prepares envelopes and chips
- Makes sure there is a chairperson for birthday meeting

Supplies

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 6 months

- The supply chairperson keeps continuous inventory of all supplies, consumables, and refreshments for the group, and makes purchases as necessary to maintain adequate levels at all times.
- To avoid duplication, all supply purchases should be made by (or coordinated through) this chairperson.
- The member volunteering for this position is required to purchase supplies using his/her resources and furnish receipts to the Treasurer for reimbursement.

Technology

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 6 months

- Helps manage meeting technology (Zoom, equipment, etc.)
- Assists with technical issues during meetings
- Manage all technology for the group including zoom, equipment, technology upgrades.

Treatment

Term: 1 year | Minimum sobriety: 1 year

- The Treatment chair is the group liaison to local treatment or rehabilitation facilities.
- Regularly visits these centers to ensure awareness of AA purposes and group activities.
- Maintains contact with District Treatment committee and represents the home group.
- Communicate carrying the message opportunities to group members.

Section 3: GROUP MEETING GUIDELINES

Meeting Safety

- Our meetings aim to provide a safe and welcoming environment.
- If someone disrupts a meeting, the chairperson may ask them to quiet down or leave.
- If safety concerns arise, members may contact appropriate authorities.

Literature

- The Rowlett Group uses AA Conference-approved literature for meeting discussions.

Facility Access

The door code is shared with trusted servants and regular members with at least three months sobriety.

Chairing Meetings

- Members who chair meetings should have six months sobriety unless with their sponsor
OR
- Have completed the Twelve Steps on Alcoholics Anonymous and chaired one meeting with their sponsor
- Chairperson may change meeting format in the following instances:
 - Newcomer at 12x12: May change the topic pages to steps 1,2,3
 - Newcomer with support person to closed meeting: May open the meeting to allow support person to attend. After meeting, explain the differences between closed and open meetings.
- Chairpersons responsibilities:
 - Pre-meeting:**
 - Familiarize yourself with the Chairperson's notebook (meeting formats, topic ideas, envelopes, readings)
 - Arrive early (30 minutes is great, 15 minutes is ok)
 - Make coffee
 - Straighten the room, fill refrigerator (Or ask others to help)
 - Meeting:**
 - Chair meeting with outline for the proper meeting type
 - Be prepared with a topic for Discussion Meetings
 - Start meeting on the hour and end on time
 - Post-meeting:**
 - Count and secure money (envelopes are in the chair book)
 - Count the money from the basket, write amount on envelope
 - Count the money from drinks, write amount on envelope
 - Count the money from literature, write amount on envelope
 - Put the meeting date and time on the envelope, place money in envelope, deposit in safe and turn the handle until envelope drops into safe.
 - Turn off the coffee pot
 - Clean kitchen
 - Wash pot
 - Fill up water bottles for coffee
 - Take out trash if full (Summer time: take out trash each evening)
 - Prepare room for next meeting
 - Turn off all lights and fans
 - Lock the front door
 - If you are unable to chair: find a replacement by reaching out to individuals DIRECTLY to ensure the meeting will be covered.